



MOZAMBIQUE

Capital city: Maputo
Area: 309,494 sq miles (801,590 sq km)
Population: 18,900,000
Official language: Portuguese
Major religions: traditional beliefs 56%, Christian 30%, Muslim 14%
Government: Multi-party democracy
Currency: Metical
Adult literacy rate: 47%
Life expectancy: 41 years
People per doctor: 50,000
Televisions: 5 per 1,000 people

Workers taking a health-care class in Mozambique

HEALTH CARE

After independence, the Mozambique government brought all health services under national ownership and provided free health care for all. However, years of civil war have destroyed most rural hospitals and clinics, and diseases such as tuberculosis, malaria, and pneumonia continue to kill many people. Today, almost the entire population lives in poverty, and more than half relies on food aid supplied from abroad. Each year Mozambique receives millions of dollars worth of aid, mainly from European nations and the US.

FARMING

More than 85 percent of Mozambique's people work on the land. Farmers grow crops such as sugar, cotton, tea, cashew nuts, and citrus fruits on the fertile coastal plains, and grow tobacco and herd cattle on the inland pastures. The seas are rich in fish, and the export of shrimp, lobster, and other seafoods provides much-needed income for the national economy.

Workers carrying bundles of sugarcane after the harvest

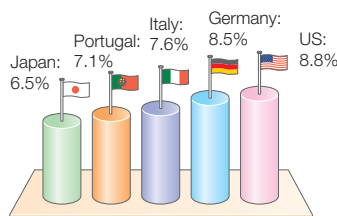


MOZAMBIQUE

WHEN MOZAMBIQUE BECAME independent from Portugal in 1975, its former rulers fled the country, destroying roads and machinery as they left. Years of civil war, drought, and flooding have since reduced the country to one of the poorest in the world. Land mines left over from the war still litter the countryside, and few bridges remain standing. But Mozambique has the potential to overcome its disastrous recent history. The land is rich and fertile, and the country's mineral resources are largely untouched.

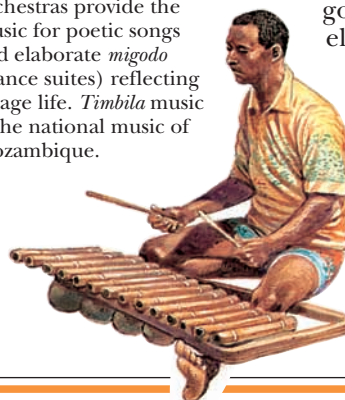


Where the aid comes from



LOCAL MUSIC

The coastal Chopi people produce music based on the sound of the *timbila*, a type of xylophone. *Timbila* orchestras provide the music for poetic songs and elaborate *migodo* (dance suites) reflecting village life. *Timbila* music is the national music of Mozambique.



BEIRA

The Indian Ocean port of Beira is the second city of Mozambique, and its major port. Most of neighboring Zimbabwe's imports and exports pass through the port, using the rail, road, and pipeline links that run between Beira and the Zimbabwean capital of Harare. During the civil war, up to 10,000 Zimbabwean soldiers guarded this vital lifeline.

During the civil war, millions of refugees fled the country or left villages to find safety in the towns.



CIVIL WAR

After independence in 1975, civil war broke out between the communist Frelimo government and the Mozambique National Resistance (Renamo) rebels, supported by South Africa. The war led to the deaths of 900,000 people and to widespread starvation. Withdrawal of international support for Renamo and the decision of the Frelimo government to hold multiparty elections resulted in a peace treaty that was signed by the two sides in 1992.

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